

9-TIME WORLD SERIES CHAMPIONS: 1903, 1912, 1915, 1916, 1918, 2004, 2007, 2013, 2018

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**BOSTON RED SOX (51-48, 3rd AL East) vs. BALTIMORE ORIOLES (49-52) —  
DOUBLEHEADER**

Fenway Park • Makeup doubleheader after Tuesday's rainout • Boston carries a 14-game winning streak in — Game 1 win ties the 1946 franchise record (15); a sweep would break it outright at 16

**Game 1, 1:35 p.m. ET (11:35 a.m. MT): LHP Jake Bennett (BOS, 5-3, 2.35) vs. RHP Dean Kremer (BAL, 1-2, 4.15) — Kremer is 3-4, 5.04 ERA in 10 career starts vs. Boston; first career look at the Orioles for Bennett**

**Game 2, 7:10 p.m. ET (5:10 p.m. MT): LHP Ranger Suárez (BOS, 4-3, 3.15) — if activated — vs. RHP Kyle Bradish (BAL, 6-9, 3.61) — Boston had not named a Game 2 starter as of Tuesday night; interim manager Chad Tracy said Suárez is "in the mix" but Eduardo Rivera remains the fallback option**

Tuesday's game was postponed by rain (storms rolled in roughly three hours before first pitch; the postponement was called about 90 minutes later) and rescheduled as this single-admission doubleheader — ticket-holders from Tuesday may use their tickets for Game 1.

Next: Blue Jays at Fenway (7/24–26), then a 4-game set at the Athletics in West Sacramento (7/27–30) — trade deadline is Mon., Aug. 3

**STATE OF THE SOX**

- Boston is 51-48 (3rd, AL East, 6.0 GB) with the winning streak frozen at **14 games** after Tuesday's rainout — the record and the streak carry over unchanged into today's doubleheader.
- At three games over .500, the Sox are as far above the break-even line as they've been all season.
- Boston has won 19 of its last 21 and holds the American League's third and final Wild Card spot outright, 1.0 game clear of Seattle.
- The climb continues: the Sox sat 15.5 games back on June 24, the low point of the season. Today, 28 days later, they are 6.0 back — 9.5 games of ground recovered.

**MONDAY: DURBIN BEATS BALTIMORE FROM BEHIND**

- Trailing 1-0 in the first, 4-3 in the sixth and 5-4 in the seventh, Boston tied it on Ceddanne Rafaela's two-out RBI single, then Caleb Durbin broke it open with a two-out solo homer over the Green Monster in the eighth — his 10th of the year — off Tyler Wells (2-2).
- Garrett Whitlock (5-1) worked a perfect eighth and Aroldis Chapman needed a leaping catch from Tsung-Che Cheng at short to close out his 22nd save.
- Baltimore committed four errors and allowed two unearned runs; Payton Tolle allowed four

**RED SOX HEADLINES****Rainout delays Boston's pursuit of a record-tying 15th straight win**

Tuesday's game against Baltimore was postponed by rain about 90 minutes after storms rolled through Fenway; the teams will play a single-admission doubleheader today instead, with the streak still parked at 14.

Boston.com • Jul 21 • [Read](#) ↗

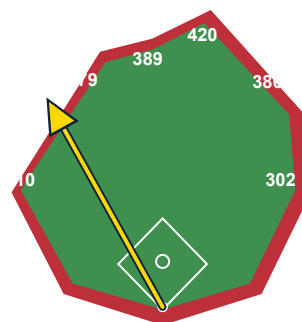
**Red Sox eye record win streak in today's doubleheader vs. Orioles**

"I want to make history here," Caleb Durbin said of the chase. Boston will start Jake Bennett opposite Dean Kremer in Game 1; no Game 2 starter was named as of Tuesday night, with Ranger Suárez "in the mix" per interim manager Chad Tracy.

Yardbarker (Field Level Media) • Jul 22 • [Read](#) ↗

**Red Sox one win shy of franchise-record streak after dramatic Fenway victory****FENWAY WEATHER**

|                                                                                                                               |                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| TEMP<br><b>82°F</b>                                                                                                           | WIND<br><b>S 13 mph</b>   |
| GUSTS<br><b>22 mph</b>                                                                                                        | FEELS LIKE<br><b>89°F</b> |
| PARK WIND<br><b>Blowing Out, Left-Center</b>                                                                                  |                           |
| Today: Light Rain, high 82°F / low 67°F, 26% chance of rain.<br><i>Live via Open-Meteo • updates when this page is opened</i> |                           |

**LIVE WIND @ FENWAY**

From S • toward N • 13 mph

Field silhouette to scale of Fenway's real dimensions; arrow calibrated to the park's true orientation (dead center ≈ 30°, home plate ≈ 230°) — not a live camera image.

- runs with nine strikeouts over 5.2 innings in a no-decision.
- Durbin is batting .351 (13-for-37) with two homers over his last 10 games, per CBS Sports/RotoWire. "You try not to think about it, but I want it," Durbin said of the record chase. "A lot of really good ballclubs have come through here, too... hopefully it's not done for a little while."

**RAINED OUT, NOT RAINED ON — DOUBLEHEADER TODAY**

- Tuesday night's game against Baltimore was postponed by rain (storms arrived roughly three hours ahead of first pitch; the postponement was called about 90 minutes later) and made up as a single-admission doubleheader today at Fenway — Game 1 at 1:35 p.m. ET, Game 2 at 7:10 p.m. ET.
- A win in Game 1 ties the 1946 Red Sox — the Ted Williams/Bobby Doerr/Dom DiMaggio/Johnny Pesky club — for the longest winning streak in the 126-year history of the franchise. Sweeping both games would break it outright at 16.
- Jake Bennett, already lined up for Wednesday's start, gets the Game 1 ball against Dean Kremer. Boston had not named a Game 2 starter as of Tuesday night; Ranger Suárez (groin) is "in the mix" per interim manager Chad Tracy, with rookie Eduardo Rivera the fallback if Suárez isn't ready. "We've just gotta wait and see how he feels tomorrow," Tracy said Tuesday.
- Willson Contreras, on the streak: "It would mean a lot, for sure... we are relentless, we are resilient. If it happens it would be great for us and we'll have to celebrate that. If it doesn't, we have to keep going."

**SHOULDER TO SHOULDER WITH 1946**

- The 1946 Red Sox won the pennant on the strength of that 15-game streak (Apr. 25–May 10) but lost the World Series in seven games to the St. Louis Cardinals — a heartbreak finish sealed by Enos Slaughter's "Mad Dash" from first on Harry Walker's eighth-inning double in Game 7, with shortstop Johnny Pesky's relay throw home often cited as a beat late. Worth remembering on a day this club is chasing that same ghost.
- Also from that summer: Cleveland player-manager Lou Boudreau debuted the radical defensive shift against Ted Williams on July 14, 1946 — the "Boudreau Shift" that still bears his name eight decades later.

**ALONE IN SECOND SINCE 1946**

- Fourteen straight moved Boston past the 1948 club's 13-game run and into sole possession of the second-longest winning streak in franchise history. Only the 1946

Three separate deficits, three separate comebacks, and a two-out, eighth-inning Durbin homer — Monday's 6-5 win over Baltimore was the latest example of a team that has forgotten how to lose.

NBC Sports Boston • Jul 20 (updated Jul 21) • [Read ↗](#)

**Only one Red Sox team has had a longer winning streak — and that season ended in the World Series**

The 1946 club won 15 straight from late April into May behind Ted Williams, Bobby Doerr and Johnny Pesky, then lost a seven-game World Series to St. Louis — a reminder that this record has a bittersweet history attached to it.

NESN • Jul 20 • [Read ↗](#)

**Red Sox make roster move after 14th straight win**

Boston recalled reliever Zack Kelly from Triple-A Worcester Tuesday and immediately placed him on the 60-day injured list with right elbow inflammation, opening a 40-man roster spot ahead of the Aug. 3 deadline.

Yardbarker (Athlon Sports) • Jul 21 • [Read ↗](#)

Headlines curated from free, non-paywalled coverage and rewritten without clickbait. The Boston Globe and other paywalled or subscription-gated outlets are never used. Listics, fluff, doom-and-gloom columns, and anonymous trade speculation are filtered out — deadline items appear only when sourced to a named club executive on the record or a top-tier national insider. Every card was date-checked and falls within the 7/19–7/22 recency window; all six cards from yesterday's edition were dropped and replaced. Note: the MLB.com Red Sox RSS feed was checked again this run and its build date is still stale, so none of its items were used.

| 2026 SEASON SNAPSHOT |                        |
|----------------------|------------------------|
| Overall              | 51-48 (.515)           |
| Home / Road          | 22-27 / 29-21          |
| AL East Standing     | 3rd (-6.0)             |
| Wild Card            | Holds 3rd (final) spot |
| Current Streak       | W14 (PPD 7/21)         |
| Last 10 / 20 / 30    | 10-0 / 18-2 / 22-8     |
| July Record          | 14-1 (1 PPD)           |
| Interim Manager      | Chad Tracy             |
| Run Diff.            | 419 RS / 373 RA (+46)  |

| AL EAST STANDINGS                                                                                                                                                             |           |           |            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|------------|
| Team                                                                                                                                                                          | W         | L         | GB         |
| Tampa Bay Rays                                                                                                                                                                | 58        | 42        | —          |
| New York Yankees                                                                                                                                                              | 56        | 44        | 2.0        |
| <b>Boston Red Sox</b>                                                                                                                                                         | <b>51</b> | <b>48</b> | <b>6.5</b> |
| Baltimore Orioles                                                                                                                                                             | 49        | 52        | 9.5        |
| Toronto Blue Jays                                                                                                                                                             | 46        | 55        | 12.5       |
| Reflects games through 7/21. Tampa Bay beat Toronto 12-2 (MLB.com Gameday); the Yankees-Pirates and Red Sox-Orioles games were both postponed for rain and did not factor in. |           |           |            |

| AL CENTRAL STANDINGS                                                                               |    |    |      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|----|------|
| Team                                                                                               | W  | L  | GB   |
| Chicago White Sox                                                                                  | 52 | 46 | —    |
| Cleveland Guardians                                                                                | 53 | 48 | 0.5  |
| Minnesota Twins                                                                                    | 49 | 52 | 4.5  |
| Detroit Tigers                                                                                     | 46 | 53 | 6.5  |
| Kansas City Royals                                                                                 | 40 | 60 | 13.0 |
| Carried forward from 7/20; Tuesday's AL Central results were not independently confirmed this run. |    |    |      |

| AL WEST STANDINGS  |    |    |      |
|--------------------|----|----|------|
| Team               | W  | L  | GB   |
| Texas Rangers      | 50 | 49 | —    |
| Seattle Mariners   | 50 | 50 | 0.5  |
| Houston Astros     | 47 | 54 | 4.0  |
| Athletics          | 42 | 57 | 8.0  |
| Los Angeles Angels | 39 | 61 | 11.5 |

team's 15-game streak, set that June, stands ahead of it.

- Starting pitchers own a 2.63 ERA during the 14-game run; relievers are even better at 1.15, per Field Level Media.

#### THE TWO-RUN TOURNIQUET

- Hold the other team to two runs or fewer and this season is essentially decided: Boston is still **34-1** in those games (Monday's five-run Baltimore output doesn't qualify). The lone blemish remains the May 12 loss to Philadelphia.
- Monday was the most runs the pitching staff has allowed in any game of the 14-game streak, but the staff still sports that 1.15 bullpen ERA and 2.63 rotation ERA across the run overall.

#### THE 5-RUN RECIPE

- Boston is 37-9 when it scores five or more and 14-39 when it doesn't — Monday's six runs kept the streak living on the right side of that split. Field Level Media has Boston averaging 5.9 runs a game over the 14-game run.

#### FENWAY, STILL A RIDDLE

- Monday's win was a home game, nudging the home ledger to 22-27 against a 29-21 road mark — still a seven-game reverse split. Eight of the next 11 are at Fenway, so the window to correct it remains open.

#### BALTIMORE, REVISITED

- Monday's win pushed the season series to 4-3 Boston with two games left in this set, now both today. Christian Encarnacion-Strand, recalled by Baltimore from Triple-A four days earlier, homered and drove in a run for the Orioles.
- The loss snapped the Orioles' season-best seven-game winning streak — making Monday's game a clash of the two hottest records in baseball entering the night.
- Baltimore is thin behind the plate: rookie Samuel Basallo (sore right shoulder) sat out Monday and wasn't slated to start Tuesday, and starting catcher Adley Rutschman went on the 10-day IL Monday with wrist inflammation. "He's feeling a little bit better today. We're very hopeful with him," Orioles manager Craig Albarnaz said of Basallo.

#### ODDS & ENDS

- Blanked and blanking:** Boston has thrown 10 shutouts and been shut out only four times.
- Coin-flip baseball:** still 3-3 in extra innings and two walk-off wins against three walk-off losses, but the one-run record improved to 10-12 with Monday's 6-5 win — the fourth of the 14 streak wins decided by a single run.

Approximate — carried from 7/20; Tuesday's AL West results were not independently confirmed this run.

#### AL WILD CARD STANDINGS

| Team                 | W         | L         | GB*      |
|----------------------|-----------|-----------|----------|
| NY Yankees (WC1)     | 56        | 44        | +4.5     |
| Cleveland (WC2)      | 53        | 48        | +1.0     |
| <b>Red Sox (WC3)</b> | <b>51</b> | <b>48</b> | <b>—</b> |
| Seattle Mariners     | 50        | 50        | 1.5      |
| Minnesota Twins      | 49        | 52        | 3.0      |
| Baltimore Orioles    | 49        | 52        | 3.0      |
| Houston Astros       | 47        | 54        | 5.0      |
| Detroit Tigers       | 46        | 53        | 5.0      |
| Toronto Blue Jays    | 46        | 55        | 6.0      |

\*GB from the final (3rd) Wild Card spot. Tampa Bay, Chicago and Texas are excluded as division leaders. Boston holds WC3 outright, 1.0 game up on Seattle.

#### TRADE DEADLINE WATCH

Deadline: Mon., Aug. 3, 4:00 p.m. MT (6:00 p.m. ET)

Craig Breslow, on not yet committing to buy: "More time means we can get more information."

Sam Kennedy and Breslow have both stressed a cautious, information-gathering posture even as the win streak has flipped Boston from apparent sellers toward the buyer's side of the market.

7/21: recalled RHP Zack Kelly and transferred him to the 60-day IL (elbow), opening a 40-man spot ahead of the deadline.

7/14: acquired OF/DH Jahmai Jones from Detroit (PTBNL) — still the only trade of the window.

- **Cycle-logical:** Monasterio's April 25 cycle at Baltimore remains the only one by a Red Sox hitter this season.
- **Month of July:** 14-1, outscoring opponents 84-39.

## ROTATION REINFORCEMENTS

- Suárez (groin) took part in Monday's throwing and pitchers' fielding drills but was held back from Tuesday's scratched start; his activation is still unresolved with the rotation that's been among the sport's best even though ace Garrett Crochet hasn't pitched since April 25.
- Jake Bennett gets today's Game 1 ball against Dean Kremer; the next open rotation turn after the doubleheader is Friday's series opener against Toronto.
- Connelly Early (left elbow) is throwing again with no return date set. Roman Anthony (finger tendon) remains in Fort Myers not yet swinging, and Trevor Story (hip/hernia surgery) is hitting and increasing defensive work with no rehab assignment scheduled.
- Boston recalled reliever Zack Kelly from Triple-A Worcester Tuesday and immediately transferred him to the 60-day IL with right elbow inflammation — a procedural move that opens a spot on the 40-man roster ahead of the deadline; Kelly won't be eligible to return before early September.

## DEADLINE WATCH

- Craig Breslow's stance hasn't hardened into a plan: "More time means we can get more information," he's told reporters — a sign the front office isn't rushing a call despite the streak.
- Tuesday's Zack Kelly transaction cracked open a 40-man roster spot, giving the front office a bit more flexibility to add without a corresponding cut.
- The only trade of the deadline window remains the 7/14 acquisition of OF/DH Jahmai Jones from Detroit (PTBNL).

## RED SOX NOTES

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

### ROTATION & BULLPEN NOTES

- Jake Bennett (5-3, 2.35 ERA) starts today's Game 1 against Dean Kremer — his first career look at Baltimore. Boston had not named a Game 2 starter as of Tuesday night; Ranger Suárez is "in the mix" per interim manager Chad Tracy, with rookie Eduardo Rivera the fallback option if Suárez isn't activated.
- Suárez (4-3, 3.15 ERA in 17 starts) took part in Monday's throwing and pitchers' fielding drills but remains on the 15-day IL with no corresponding move made. He's 0-2 with a 4.32 ERA in four career starts against Baltimore.

- Eduardo Rivera is 0-0 with a 2.89 ERA across three appearances (two starts) and would be Wednesday's Game 2 option if Suárez isn't ready; Boston has won both of his prior starts.
- Payton Tolle allowed four runs on nine strikeouts over 5.2 innings in Monday's no-decision; Garrett Whitlock (5-1) worked a perfect eighth and Aroldis Chapman logged his 22nd save.
- Connelly Early (left elbow, 15-day IL) is throwing again; no return date set. Garrett Crochet (shoulder inflammation/lat, 60-day IL) still has not thrown a baseball since April 25 and told reporters this week it's "tough to say" whether he could miss the rest of the season.
- Tanner Houck, Kutter Crawford and Johan Oviedo remain on the 60-day IL. Boston recalled Zack Kelly from Triple-A Worcester Tuesday and immediately transferred him to the 60-day IL with right elbow inflammation, opening a 40-man spot; he won't be eligible to return before early September. Joe La Sorsa remains on the 7-day IL.
- Aroldis Chapman has 22 saves and a 2.05 ERA at age 38, with 38 strikeouts in 30.2 innings (through 7/19; Monday's scoreless save not yet folded into the rate line — see source note). He set the all-time reliever strikeout record on July 4 against the Angels.
- Patrick Sandoval carries a 4.82 ERA in 9.1 innings across two starts since returning from a long layoff; his rotation spot remains squeezed with Suárez close to activation.

STARTER LOOK, GAME 1: Jake Bennett (BOS) vs. Dean Kremer (BAL) — 1:35 p.m. ET

|                    | W-L | ERA  | IP   | SO | WHIP  |
|--------------------|-----|------|------|----|-------|
| Jake Bennett (LHP) | 5-3 | 2.35 | 53.2 | 38 | 0.876 |
| Dean Kremer (RHP)  | 1-2 | 4.15 | —    | —  | —     |

Bennett's line from the Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox pitching table. Kremer's W-L/ERA are from Field Level Media's Jul 22 doubleheader preview; his 2026 IP/SO/WHIP were not available via a verified source this run. Kremer is 3-4 with a 5.04 ERA in 10 career starts against Boston; this is Bennett's first career start against the Orioles.

STARTER LOOK, GAME 2: Ranger Suárez or Eduardo Rivera (BOS) vs. Kyle Bradish (BAL) — 7:10 p.m. ET

|                      | W-L | ERA  | IP    | SO  | WHIP  |
|----------------------|-----|------|-------|-----|-------|
| Ranger Suárez (LHP)  | 4-3 | 3.15 | 91.1  | 97  | 1.161 |
| Eduardo Rivera (LHP) | 0-0 | 2.89 | 9.1   | 9   | 0.964 |
| Kyle Bradish (RHP)   | 6-9 | 3.61 | ~89.0 | ~94 | ~1.45 |

Boston had not named a Game 2 starter as of Tuesday night, per Field Level Media; Suárez and Rivera lines shown from the Baseball-Reference pitching table for comparison. Bradish's W-L/ERA are sourced to Field Level Media's Jul 22 preview; his IP/SO/WHIP are approximate due to conflicting cached snapshots found this run and should be treated as directional, not exact. Bradish is 1-6 with a 6.75 ERA in 10 career starts against Boston but is coming off a 6.2-inning, 1-run outing against Kansas City on July 11.

PITCHER LINES

Sonny Gray

ACE

12-1, 2.48 ERA, 101.2 IP, 90 SO, 1.121 WHIP, 18 GS

- Did not pitch Monday; next scheduled to line up later in the Toronto series.

Payton Tolle

5-6, 3.11 ERA, 84.0 IP, 87 SO, 1.071 WHIP, 15 GS

- Monday vs. Baltimore: 5.2 IP, 4 R, 9 K, no decision in the 6-5 win. Cumulative line still reflects games through 7/19 — see source note.

Connelly Early

15-DAY IL

7-5, 3.44 ERA, 91.2 IP, 93 SO, 1.255 WHIP, 17 GS

- Left elbow; throwing again. No return date.

Ranger Suárez

AS15-DAY IL

4-3, 3.15 ERA, 91.1 IP, 97 SO, 1.161 WHIP, 17 GS

- Groin strain; activation pushed back Tuesday afternoon for an extra recovery day. No corresponding move made.

Jake Bennett

5-3, 2.35 ERA, 53.2 IP, 38 SO, 0.876 WHIP, 9 GS

- Best ERA and WHIP of any Boston starter; gets today's Game 1 ball vs. Dean Kremer.

Aroldis Chapman

ASCL

1-3, 2.05 ERA, 22 SV, 30.2 IP, 38 SO, 1.207 WHIP, 33 G

- Closed out Monday's win for his 22nd save, needing a leaping catch from Tsung-Che Cheng at short to finish it. Set the all-time reliever strikeout record July 4 vs. the Angels.

Garrett Whitlock

5-1, 2.06 ERA, 2 SV, 36.0 IP, 38 SO, 0.914 WHIP, 37 G

- Perfect eighth inning Monday earned the win; best WHIP in the bullpen.

Jovani Morán

2-2, 2.61 ERA, 41.1 IP, 46 SO, 0.944 WHIP, 27 G

- 10.0 K/9 and a sub-1.000 WHIP; has made three spot starts.

Tyron Guerrero

1-1, 2.21 ERA, 20.1 IP, 24 SO, 1.033 WHIP, 20 G

- Two walks all season — a 12.00 K/BB ratio.

Greg Weissert

2-2, 3.66 ERA, 39.1 IP, 36 SO, 1.220 WHIP, 41 G

- Team leader in appearances.

Ryan Watson

-

**Brayan Bello**

2-6, 6.06 ERA, 65.1 IP, 49 SO, 1.592 WHIP, 8 GS

- The staff's clear soft spot; has been used out of the bullpen recently.

**Patrick Sandoval**

0-0, 4.82 ERA, 9.1 IP, 10 SO, 1.714 WHIP, 2 GS

- Rotation spot squeezed further with Suárez close to activation.

**Garrett Crochet** 60-DAY IL

3-3, 6.30 ERA, 30.0 IP, 37 SO, 1.467 WHIP, 6 GS

- Shoulder inflammation and lat strain; has not thrown since April 25. September at the earliest.

**Eduardo Rivera**

0-0, 2.89 ERA, 9.1 IP, 9 SO, 0.964 WHIP

- 23-year-old lefty; the fallback Game 2 starter today if Suárez isn't activated. Boston has won both of his prior starts.

**Tanner Houck** 60-DAY IL

No 2026 major-league appearances

**Kutter Crawford** 60-DAY IL

No 2026 major-league appearances

1-0, 4.53 ERA, 1 SV, 51.2 IP, 42 SO, 1.297 WHIP, 32 G

- Rookie workhorse.

**Justin Slaten**

1-4, 5.40 ERA, 23.1 IP, 32 SO, 1.500 WHIP, 27 G

- 12.3 K/9 but has been hit hard; 3.36 FIP suggests better days.

**Zack Kelly** 60-DAY IL

0-2, 3.31 ERA, 16.1 IP, 14 SO, 1.286 WHIP, 17 G

- Recalled from Worcester and transferred straight to the 60-day IL Tuesday with right elbow inflammation; not eligible to return before early September.

**Joe La Sorsa** 7-DAY IL

0-0, 27.00 ERA, 0.1 IP, 1 SO, 3.000 WHIP, 1 G

**Johan Oviedo** 60-DAY IL

0-0, 9.82 ERA, 3.2 IP, 3 SO, 1.909 WHIP, 1 G

**Tyler Samaniego** MINORS (40-MAN)

0-3, 2.66 ERA, 20.1 IP, 17 SO, 1.475 WHIP, 20 G

**Alec Gamboa** MINORS (40-MAN)

0-0, 2.25 ERA, 1 SV, 8.0 IP, 5 SO, 1.125 WHIP, 5 G

**Tyler Uberstine** MINORS (40-MAN)

0-1, 3.38 ERA, 2.2 IP, 2 SO, 1.500 WHIP, 1 G

Cumulative pitching lines are from the Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox standard pitching table through games of 7/19/2026, carried forward unchanged — Monday's box-score facts (Whitlock's win, Chapman's 22nd save) were described narratively rather than folded into the rate stats, and Tuesday's scheduled game was postponed, so nothing has changed since yesterday's edition. Zack Kelly's IL tag was updated to 60-day based on Tuesday's confirmed transaction (Yardbarker/Athlon Sports); his rate stats are unchanged from his last MLB action. Danny Coulombe, Tommy Kahnle and Jack Anderson appear in the season pitching log but are no longer on the 40-man roster and are omitted here.

**RED SOX NOTES**

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

**LINEUP NOTES**

- Caleb Durbin's two-out solo homer over the Green Monster in the eighth inning Monday broke a 5-5 tie and delivered the 14th straight win — his 10th home run of the year. He's batting .351 (13-for-37) over his last 10 games, per CBS Sports/RotoWire, and his season line below has been updated for the home run and RBI.
- Ceddanne Rafaela tied Monday's game with a two-out RBI single in the seventh — his 4.2 team-leading WAR pairs a .761 OPS with 17 defensive runs saved in center field (through 7/19).
- Willson Contreras (AS) remains the offense's anchor: a team-best .932 OPS, 22 homers, 64 RBI and a 162 OPS+ through Sunday's game.
- Jarren Duran's .190 average and 116 strikeouts are the lineup's most conspicuous problem, though 13 homers and 14 steals keep him productive at the margins.
- Boston has scored five or more in 46 of 99 games and is 37-9 in those. The lineup, not the staff, is what Craig Breslow has repeatedly named as the likeliest deadline addition.
- Game 1 lineup per pregame reporting: Yoshida DH, Rafaela CF, Abreu RF, Contreras 1B, Durbin 3B, González 2B, Duran LF, Wong C, Cheng SS — a lineup shuffle that sits Seigler and Monasterio for the opener. Game 2 lineup was not yet posted at publication time.
- Full B-Ref batting page: [baseball-reference.com/teams/BOS/2026.shtml#all\\_players\\_standard\\_batting](https://baseball-reference.com/teams/BOS/2026.shtml#all_players_standard_batting)

**HITTER LINES****Willson Contreras (1B)** AS

.283/.380/.551, 22 HR, 64 RBI, 91 G, 162 OPS+

- Team-best .932 OPS. Did not play a decisive role Monday; line reflects games through 7/19.

**Romy González (IF)**

.184/.273/.306, 1 HR, 6 RBI, 14 G

**Jahmai Jones (DH/OF)**

.400/.500/1.000, 1 HR, 2 RBI, 3 G



**Ceddanne Rafaela (CF)** **AS**

.281/.326/.435, 8 HR, 41 RBI, 13 SB, 94 G

- Tied Monday's game with a two-out RBI single in the seventh; RBI total not yet incremented pending final box score — see source note.

**Wilyer Abreu (RF)**

.264/.337/.458, 15 HR, 49 RBI, 96 G, 125 OPS+

- Four homers over back-to-back multi-homer games July 17–18, a first for a Red Sox hitter since Betts in 2016.

**Caleb Durbin (3B)**

.236/.299/.392, 10 HR, 42 RBI, 11 SB, 92 G

- Monday's game-winner: a two-out solo shot over the Monster in the eighth off Tyler Wells, his 10th homer of the year. Batting .351 (13-for-37) over his last 10 games; AVG/OBP/SLG above still reflect games through 7/19 pending the final rate-stat recompute.

**Jarren Duran (LF)**

.190/.254/.340, 13 HR, 48 RBI, 14 SB, 116 SO in 91 G

- Power and speed intact; the batting average is not.

**Masataka Yoshida (DH)**

.267/.343/.401, 4 HR, 18 RBI, 64 G

- Primarily a DH (44 games there); 17 pinch-hit appearances.

**Andruw Monasterio (SS)**

.239/.295/.436, 5 HR, 17 RBI, 60 G

- Hit for the cycle 4/25 at Baltimore in a 17-1 win; most games at shortstop (20) among four positions played.

**Connor Wong (C)**

.276/.375/.371, 1 HR, 15 RBI, 44 G

- Highest OBP among Boston regulars.

**Anthony Seigler (2B)**

.256/.330/.407, 2 HR, 7 RBI, 25 G, 109 OPS+

- Made a fielding error on a potential double-play ball in the seventh Monday that helped Baltimore retake the lead; all his 2026 defensive games remain at second base — he is a second baseman in 2026, not a catcher.

**Carlos Narváez (C)**

.200/.266/.294, 3 HR, 9 RBI, 55 G

- Primary catcher by workload (54 games behind the plate).

**Tsung-Che Cheng (SS)**

.303/.368/.333, 0 HR, 5 RBI, 12 G

- Made a leaping catch on Tyler O'Neill's game-ending liner (.890 expected average) to seal Monday's win.

- Acquired from Detroit 7/14; homered in his first start with the club.

**Isiah Kiner-Falefa (2B)** **10-DAY IL**

.277/.344/.361, 2 HR, 13 RBI, 7 SB, 47 G

- Most games at second (27); also logged time at short and third.

**Marcelo Mayer (2B)** **10-DAY IL**

.220/.282/.312, 3 HR, 22 RBI, 70 G

- 45 games at second base, 24 at shortstop.

**Trevor Story (SS)** **60-DAY IL**

.206/.244/.303, 3 HR, 19 RBI, 41 G

- Sports-hernia surgery 5/22; hitting again and increasing defensive work, no rehab assignment set.

**Roman Anthony (LF)** **60-DAY IL**

.229/.354/.321, 1 HR, 5 RBI, 30 G

- Partially torn tendon, right ring finger; rehabbing in Fort Myers, not yet swinging. August at the earliest.

**Triston Casas (1B)** **60-DAY IL**

No 2026 major-league appearances

**Mickey Gasper (C/UT)** **MINORS (40-MAN)**

.243/.305/.308, 0 HR, 7 RBI, 34 G

**Nick Sogard (IF)** **MINORS (40-MAN)**

.257/.350/.371, 0 HR, 2 RBI, 12 G

**Nate Eaton (OF)** **MINORS (40-MAN)**

.125/.282/.281, 1 HR, 5 RBI, 14 G

**Brett Harris (1B)** **MINORS (40-MAN)**

.000/.333/.000, 0 HR, 0 RBI, 1 G

**Kristian Campbell (IF)** **MINORS (40-MAN)**

No 2026 major-league appearances

Batting lines from the Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox standard batting table, through games of 7/19/2026, except Caleb Durbin's HR/RBI/G total, which were incremented for his confirmed 10th home run Monday (CBS Sports/RotoWire, MLB.com); his rate stats (AVG/OBP/SLG) were left as of 7/19 rather than estimated, since exact updated at-bat totals were not available via a verified box score this run. The same caution applies to Rafaela's RBI, which is described narratively above rather than incremented. No games were played Tuesday (postponed), so these lines are unchanged from yesterday's edition. The Game 1 batting order is per pregame preview aggregators, cross-referenced across multiple outlets rather than tied to a single paywalled source. Listed positions are assigned by most games played at each spot in the "Full Season Roster & Appearances" table rather than by the roster page's generic position column — which is why Anthony Seigler appears as a second baseman and Andruw Monasterio as a shortstop.

## 26-MAN ACTIVE ROSTER

| #  | Player               | Pos   | Age | B/T | Status                   |
|----|----------------------|-------|-----|-----|--------------------------|
| 44 | Aroldis Chapman AS   | P     | 38  | L/L | Closer — 22 SV           |
| 22 | Garrett Whitlock     | P     | 30  | R/R |                          |
| 54 | Sonny Gray           | P     | 36  | R/R |                          |
| 56 | Ryan Watson          | P     | 28  | R/R |                          |
| 57 | Greg Weissert        | P     | 31  | R/R |                          |
| 66 | Brayan Bello         | P     | 27  | R/R |                          |
| 43 | Patrick Sandoval     | P     | 29  | L/L |                          |
| 47 | Jovani Morán         | P     | 29  | L/L |                          |
| 63 | Justin Slaten        | P     | 28  | R/R |                          |
| 64 | Jake Bennett         | P     | 25  | L/L | Starts Game 1 vs. Kremer |
| 99 | Eduardo Rivera       | P     | 23  | L/L | Game 2 fallback starter  |
| 70 | Payton Tolle         | P     | 23  | L/L |                          |
| 41 | Tyron Guerrero       | P     | 35  | R/R |                          |
| 16 | Jarren Duran         | LF    | 29  | L/R |                          |
| 39 | Tsung-Che Cheng      | SS    | 24  | L/R |                          |
| 3  | Ceddanne Rafaela AS  | CF    | 25  | R/R |                          |
| 5  | Caleb Durbin         | 3B    | 26  | R/R |                          |
| 48 | Anthony Seigler      | 2B    | 27  | S/R | 25 G at 2B in 2026       |
| 7  | Masataka Yoshida     | DH    | 32  | L/R |                          |
| 52 | Wilyer Abreu         | RF    | 27  | L/L |                          |
| 40 | Willson Contreras AS | 1B    | 34  | R/R |                          |
| 75 | Carlos Narváez       | C     | 27  | R/R |                          |
| 23 | Romy González        | IF    | 29  | R/R |                          |
| 37 | Jahmai Jones         | DH/OF | 28  | R/R | Acquired from DET 7/14   |
| 32 | Andruw Monasterio    | SS    | 29  | R/R |                          |
| 12 | Connor Wong          | C     | 30  | R/R |                          |

## 40-MAN ROSTER — REMAINDER (IL + optioned/minors)

| #  | Player             | Pos | Age | B/T | Status                                         |
|----|--------------------|-----|-----|-----|------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | Isiah Kiner-Falefa | 2B  | 31  | R/R | 10-day IL                                      |
| 11 | Marcelo Mayer      | 2B  | 23  | L/R | 10-day IL                                      |
| 71 | Connelly Early     | P   | 24  | L/L | 15-day IL — Left elbow; throwing, no date set  |
| 55 | Ranger Suárez AS   | P   | 30  | L/L | 15-day IL — "In the mix" to start Game 2 today |
| 60 | Joe La Sorsa       | P   | 28  | L/L | 7-day IL                                       |
| 68 | Alec Gamboa        | P   | 29  | S/L | Minors (40-man)                                |
| 79 | Tyler Uberstine    | P   | 27  | R/R | Minors (40-man)                                |
| 78 | Tyler Samaniego    | P   | 27  | R/L | Minors (40-man)                                |



|    |                   |      |    |     |                                             |
|----|-------------------|------|----|-----|---------------------------------------------|
| 20 | Nick Sogard       | IF   | 28 | S/R | Minors (40-man)                             |
| 18 | Nate Eaton        | OF   | 29 | R/R | Minors (40-man)                             |
| 30 | Mickey Gasper     | C/UT | 30 | S/R | Minors (40-man)                             |
| 28 | Kristian Campbell | IF   | 24 | R/R | Minors (40-man) — No MLB action yet in 2026 |
| 25 | Brett Harris      | IF   | 28 | R/R | Minors (40-man)                             |

| 60-DAY IL (outside the 40-man count) |                 |     |     |     |                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------|-----|-----|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #                                    | Player          | Pos | Age | B/T | Status                                                                                               |
| 89                                   | Tanner Houck    | P   | 30  | R/R | 60-day IL                                                                                            |
| 50                                   | Kutter Crawford | P   | 30  | R/R | 60-day IL                                                                                            |
| 29                                   | Johan Oviedo    | P   | 28  | R/R | 60-day IL                                                                                            |
| 76                                   | Zack Kelly      | P   | 31  | R/R | 60-day IL — Right elbow inflammation; recalled/transferred 7/21, not eligible before September       |
| 35                                   | Garrett Crochet | P   | 27  | L/L | 60-day IL — Shoulder/lat; no throwing since 4/25, said it's "tough to say" if he's done for the year |
| 19                                   | Roman Anthony   | LF  | 22  | L/R | 60-day IL — Finger tendon; rehabbing in Fort Myers, not swinging                                     |
| 36                                   | Triston Casas   | 1B  | 26  | L/R | 60-day IL                                                                                            |
| 10                                   | Trevor Story    | SS  | 33  | R/R | 60-day IL — Hitting, increasing defensive work                                                       |

Roster from the Baseball-Reference 2026 40-man roster page, updated for Tuesday's confirmed transaction: RHP Zack Kelly was recalled from Triple-A Worcester and immediately transferred to the 60-day IL with right elbow inflammation, which opens a spot on the 40-man (he now sits outside the 40-man count, alongside the other 60-day IL players below). Active/IL/optioned status otherwise reflects Tuesday's reporting on the Suárez/Rivera Game 2 decision, which had not been finalized as of Tuesday night. The only trade of the deadline window so far is the 7/14 acquisition of Jahmai Jones from Detroit. Positions assigned by 2026 games played per the appearances table.

| RED SOX NOTES                                                      |            |        |      |          |      |    |      |                                 |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|------|----------|------|----|------|---------------------------------|--|
| Wednesday, July 22, 2026                                           |            |        |      |          |      |    |      |                                 |  |
| 2026 DAY-BY-DAY RESULTS (through 7/21 — 51-48, one game postponed) |            |        |      |          |      |    |      |                                 |  |
| Gm                                                                 | Date       | Opp    | W/L  | Score    | Rec  | Rk | GB   | Decisions                       |  |
| 1                                                                  | Thu Mar 26 | @ CIN  | W    | 3-0      | 1-0  | 1  | Tied | Crochet / Johnson / Chapman     |  |
| 2                                                                  | Sat Mar 28 | @ CIN  | L wo | 5-6 (11) | 1-1  | 3  | 1.5  | Phillips / Slaten               |  |
| 3                                                                  | Sun Mar 29 | @ CIN  | L    | 2-3      | 1-2  | 4  | 2.0  | Burke / Weissert / Pagán        |  |
| 4                                                                  | Mon Mar 30 | @ HOU  | L    | 1-8      | 1-3  | 5  | 2.0  | McCullers / Suarez              |  |
| 5                                                                  | Tue Mar 31 | @ HOU  | L    | 2-9      | 1-4  | 5  | 3.0  | Brown / Bello / Bolton          |  |
| 6                                                                  | Wed Apr 1  | @ HOU  | L    | 4-6      | 1-5  | 5  | 4.0  | Burrows / Crochet / Abreu       |  |
| 7                                                                  | Fri Apr 3  | vs SDP | W    | 5-2      | 2-5  | 4  | 4.0  | Gray / King / Chapman           |  |
| 8                                                                  | Sat Apr 4  | vs SDP | L    | 2-3      | 2-6  | 5  | 5.0  | Morejón / Chapman / Miller      |  |
| 9                                                                  | Sun Apr 5  | vs SDP | L    | 6-8      | 2-7  | 5  | 5.0  | Estrada / Uberstine / Miller    |  |
| 10                                                                 | Mon Apr 6  | vs MIL | L    | 6-8      | 2-8  | 5  | 5.5  | Ashby / Whitlock / Zepa         |  |
| 11                                                                 | Tue Apr 7  | vs MIL | W    | 3-2      | 3-8  | 5  | 5.5  | Crochet / Misiorowski / Chapman |  |
| 12                                                                 | Wed Apr 8  | vs MIL | W    | 5-0      | 4-8  | 5  | 4.5  | Gray / Drohan                   |  |
| 13                                                                 | Fri Apr 10 | @ STL  | L    | 2-3      | 4-9  | 5  | 4.0  | May / Kelly / O'Brien           |  |
| 14                                                                 | Sat Apr 11 | @ STL  | W    | 7-1      | 5-9  | 5  | 3.0  | Suarez / Leahy                  |  |
| 15                                                                 | Sun Apr 12 | @ STL  | W    | 9-3      | 6-9  | 4  | 2.0  | Bello / Pallante                |  |
| 16                                                                 | Mon Apr 13 | @ MIN  | L    | 6-13     | 6-10 | 5  | 3.0  | Ober / Crochet                  |  |

|    |               |           |         |             |           |   |      |                                      |
|----|---------------|-----------|---------|-------------|-----------|---|------|--------------------------------------|
| 17 | Tue<br>Apr 14 | @<br>MIN  | L       | 0-6         | 6-<br>11  | 5 | 3.5  | Abel / Gray                          |
| 18 | Wed<br>Apr 15 | @<br>MIN  | W       | 9-5         | 7-<br>11  | 5 | 3.5  | Early / Woods<br>Richardson          |
| 19 | Fri Apr<br>17 | vs<br>DET | W<br>wo | 1-0<br>(10) | 8-<br>11  | 4 | 3.0  | Whitlock / Vest                      |
| 20 | Sat<br>Apr 18 | vs<br>DET | L       | 1-4         | 8-<br>12  | 4 | 4.0  | Skubal / Bello /<br>Jansen           |
| 21 | Sun<br>Apr 19 | vs<br>DET | L       | 2-6         | 8-<br>13  | 4 | 4.5  | Valdez / Crochet                     |
| 22 | Mon<br>Apr 20 | vs<br>DET | W       | 8-6         | 9-<br>13  | 4 | 4.0  | Whitlock / Holton<br>/ Chapman       |
| 23 | Tue<br>Apr 21 | vs<br>NYY | L       | 0-4         | 9-<br>14  | 5 | 5.0  | Gil / Early                          |
| 24 | Wed<br>Apr 22 | vs<br>NYY | L       | 1-4         | 9-<br>15  | 5 | 6.0  | Fried / Suarez                       |
| 25 | Thu<br>Apr 23 | vs<br>NYY | L       | 2-4         | 9-<br>16  | 5 | 7.0  | Schlittler /<br>Coulombe /<br>Bednar |
| 26 | Fri Apr<br>24 | @<br>BAL  | L       | 3-10        | 9-<br>17  | 5 | 8.0  | Young / Bello                        |
| 27 | Sat<br>Apr 25 | @<br>BAL  | W       | 17-1        | 10-<br>17 | 5 | 8.0  | Crochet / Rogers                     |
| 28 | Sun<br>Apr 26 | @<br>BAL  | W       | 5-3         | 11-<br>17 | 5 | 7.0  | Early / Bradish /<br>Chapman         |
| 29 | Mon<br>Apr 27 | @<br>TOR  | W       | 5-0         | 12-<br>17 | 5 | 7.0  | Suarez / Cease                       |
| 30 | Tue<br>Apr 28 | @<br>TOR  | L       | 0-3         | 12-<br>18 | 5 | 8.0  | Yesavage / Tolle /<br>Varland        |
| 31 | Wed<br>Apr 29 | @<br>TOR  | L       | 1-8         | 12-<br>19 | 5 | 8.0  | Fisher / Bello                       |
| 32 | Fri<br>May 1  | vs<br>HOU | W       | 3-1         | 13-<br>19 | 5 | 8.0  | Bennett /<br>Burrows /<br>Chapman    |
| 33 | Sat<br>May 2  | vs<br>HOU | L       | 3-6         | 13-<br>20 | 5 | 9.0  | Arrighetti / Early /<br>King         |
| 34 | Sun<br>May 3  | vs<br>HOU | L       | 1-3<br>(10) | 13-<br>21 | 5 | 10.0 | Abreu / Kelly                        |
| 35 | Mon<br>May 4  | @<br>DET  | W       | 5-4         | 14-<br>21 | 5 | 10.0 | Tolle / Vanasco /<br>Chapman         |
| 36 | Tue<br>May 5  | @<br>DET  | W       | 10-3        | 15-<br>21 | 5 | 10.0 | Bello / Valdez                       |
| 37 | Wed<br>May 6  | @<br>DET  | W       | 4-0         | 16-<br>21 | 4 | 9.0  | Gray / Flaherty                      |
| 38 | Thu<br>May 7  | vs<br>TBR | L       | 4-8         | 16-<br>22 | 5 | 10.0 | Bigge / Bennett                      |
| 39 | Fri<br>May 8  | vs<br>TBR | W       | 2-0         | 17-<br>22 | 4 | 9.0  | Early / Scholtens<br>/ Chapman       |
| 40 | Sun<br>May 10 | vs<br>TBR | L       | 1-4         | 17-<br>23 | 5 | 9.5  | Martinez / Tolle /<br>Baker          |
| 41 | Tue<br>May 12 | vs<br>PHI | L       | 1-2         | 17-<br>24 | 5 | 11.0 | Wheeler / Morán<br>/ Duran           |
| 42 | Wed<br>May 13 | vs<br>PHI | W       | 3-1         | 18-<br>24 | 5 | 10.0 | Gray / Banks /<br>Chapman            |

|    |               |           |         |             |           |    |      |                                     |
|----|---------------|-----------|---------|-------------|-----------|----|------|-------------------------------------|
| 43 | Thu<br>May 14 | vs<br>PHI | L       | 1-3         | 18-<br>25 | 5  | 10.5 | Keller /<br>Samaniego /<br>Duran    |
| 44 | Fri<br>May 15 | @<br>ATL  | L<br>wo | 2-3<br>(10) | 18-<br>26 | 5  | 11.5 | Fuentes /<br>Samaniego              |
| 45 | Sat<br>May 16 | @<br>ATL  | W       | 3-2         | 19-<br>26 | 5  | 10.5 | Tolle / Elder /<br>Chapman          |
| 46 | Sun<br>May 17 | @<br>ATL  | L       | 1-8         | 19-<br>27 | 5  | 11.5 | Holmes / Bello                      |
| 47 | Mon<br>May 18 | @<br>KCR  | W       | 3-1         | 20-<br>27 | 5  | 11.5 | Gray / Lugo /<br>Chapman            |
| 48 | Tue<br>May 19 | @<br>KCR  | W       | 7-1         | 21-<br>27 | 3  | 11.5 | Whitlock / Falter                   |
| 49 | Wed<br>May 20 | @<br>KCR  | W       | 4-3         | 22-<br>27 | 3  | 11.5 | Early / Cruz /<br>Chapman           |
| Gm | Date          | Opp       | W/L     | Score       | Rec       | Rk | GB   | Decisions                           |
| 50 | Fri<br>May 22 | vs<br>MIN | L       | 6-8         | 22-<br>28 | 4  | 12.5 | Adams / Slaten /<br>Banda           |
| 51 | Sat<br>May 23 | vs<br>MIN | L       | 2-4         | 22-<br>29 | 4  | 13.0 | Bradley / Morán /<br>Rogers         |
| 52 | Sun<br>May 24 | vs<br>MIN | L       | 5-6         | 22-<br>30 | 5  | 13.0 | Ober / Guerrero /<br>Adams          |
| 53 | Tue<br>May 26 | vs<br>ATL | L       | 6-7         | 22-<br>31 | 5  | 12.5 | Strider / Suarez /<br>Iglesias      |
| 54 | Wed<br>May 27 | vs<br>ATL | W       | 8-0         | 23-<br>31 | 5  | 11.5 | Early / Elder                       |
| 55 | Thu<br>May 28 | vs<br>ATL | L       | 2-10        | 23-<br>32 | 5  | 12.0 | Sale / Coulombe                     |
| 56 | Fri<br>May 29 | @<br>CLE  | L       | 3-4         | 23-<br>33 | 5  | 13.0 | Holderman /<br>Samaniego /<br>Smith |
| 57 | Sat<br>May 30 | @<br>CLE  | W       | 9-1         | 24-<br>33 | 5  | 12.0 | Gray / Festa                        |
| 58 | Sun<br>May 31 | @<br>CLE  | W       | 9-4         | 25-<br>33 | 5  | 12.0 | Morán /<br>Holderman                |
| 59 | Tue<br>Jun 2  | vs<br>BAL | L       | 2-4         | 25-<br>34 | 5  | 11.5 | Baz / Early /<br>Garcia             |
| 60 | Wed<br>Jun 3  | vs<br>BAL | W       | 8-1         | 26-<br>34 | 5  | 10.5 | Tolle / Bassitt /<br>Watson         |
| 61 | Thu<br>Jun 4  | vs<br>BAL | L       | 2-8         | 26-<br>35 | 5  | 11.0 | Rogers / Bello                      |
| 62 | Fri<br>Jun 5  | @<br>NYY  | W       | 5-3         | 27-<br>35 | 5  | 11.0 | Gray / Weathers /<br>Chapman        |
| 63 | Sun<br>Jun 7  | @<br>NYY  | L       | 1-6         | 27-<br>36 | 5  | 10.5 | Hill / Slaten                       |

|    |               |           |      |      |           |   |      |                                            |
|----|---------------|-----------|------|------|-----------|---|------|--------------------------------------------|
| 64 | Mon<br>Jun 8  | @<br>TBR  | L    | 1-3  | 27-<br>37 | 5 | 11.5 | Legumina / Early /<br>Baker                |
| 65 | Tue<br>Jun 9  | @<br>TBR  | L    | 3-4  | 27-<br>38 | 5 | 12.5 | Martinez / Tolle /<br>Baker                |
| 66 | Wed<br>Jun 10 | @<br>TBR  | L    | 5-7  | 27-<br>39 | 5 | 13.5 | Rasmussen /<br>Bennett /<br>Cleavinger     |
| 67 | Fri<br>Jun 12 | vs<br>TEX | W    | 10-1 | 28-<br>39 | 5 | 12.5 | Gray / Leiter                              |
| 68 | Sat<br>Jun 13 | vs<br>TEX | W    | 6-3  | 29-<br>39 | 5 | 12.5 | Whitlock / Winn /<br>Chapman               |
| 69 | Sun<br>Jun 14 | vs<br>TEX | L    | 4-6  | 29-<br>40 | 5 | 13.5 | Eovaldi / Early /<br>Latz                  |
| 70 | Tue<br>Jun 16 | vs<br>TOR | L    | 1-6  | 29-<br>41 | 5 | 14.5 | Cease / Tolle /<br>Varland                 |
| 71 | Wed<br>Jun 17 | vs<br>TOR | L    | 0-3  | 29-<br>42 | 5 | 15.5 | Woods<br>Richardson /<br>Bennett / Varland |
| 72 | Thu<br>Jun 18 | vs<br>TOR | L    | 3-4  | 29-<br>43 | 5 | 15.5 | Nance / Chapman<br>/ Fluharty              |
| 73 | Fri<br>Jun 19 | @<br>SEA  | W    | 6-2  | 30-<br>43 | 5 | 15.5 | Suarez / Miller                            |
| 74 | Sat<br>Jun 20 | @<br>SEA  | W    | 5-1  | 31-<br>43 | 5 | 14.5 | Early / Hancock                            |
| 75 | Sun<br>Jun 21 | @<br>SEA  | L    | 1-3  | 31-<br>44 | 5 | 14.5 | Gilbert / Tolle /<br>Muñoz                 |
| 76 | Mon<br>Jun 22 | @<br>COL  | L wo | 2-3  | 31-<br>45 | 5 | 14.5 | Vodnik /<br>Chapman                        |
| 77 | Tue<br>Jun 23 | @<br>COL  | W    | 5-2  | 32-<br>45 | 5 | 14.5 | Gray / Sullivan                            |
| 78 | Wed<br>Jun 24 | @<br>COL  | L    | 6-8  | 32-<br>46 | 5 | 15.5 | Senzatela /<br>Slaten / Herget             |
| 79 | Thu<br>Jun 25 | vs<br>NYY | W    | 6-3  | 33-<br>46 | 5 | 14.5 | Early / Schlittler /<br>Chapman            |
| 80 | Fri<br>Jun 26 | vs<br>NYY | W    | 6-1  | 34-<br>46 | 5 | 13.5 | Tolle / Warren                             |

|    |                      |           |         |             |           |   |      |                                     |
|----|----------------------|-----------|---------|-------------|-----------|---|------|-------------------------------------|
| 81 | Sat<br>Jun 27        | vs<br>NYY | W       | 4-1         | 35-<br>46 | 5 | 12.5 | Bennett / Cole /<br>Chapman         |
| 82 | Sun<br>Jun 28        | vs<br>NYY | W<br>wo | 5-4<br>(10) | 36-<br>46 | 5 | 12.5 | Slaten / Cruz                       |
| 83 | Mon<br>Jun 29        | vs<br>WSN | W       | 6-3         | 37-<br>46 | 5 | 12.0 | Suarez / Mikolas /<br>Whitlock      |
| 84 | Tue<br>Jun 30        | vs<br>WSN | L       | 1-8         | 37-<br>47 | 5 | 13.0 | Cavalli / Weissert                  |
| 85 | Wed<br>Jul 1         | vs<br>WSN | L       | 2-10        | 37-<br>48 | 5 | 14.0 | Alvarez / Tolle                     |
| 86 | Fri<br>Jul 3         | @<br>LAA  | W       | 5-2         | 38-<br>48 | 5 | 14.5 | Bennett / Detmers<br>/ Chapman      |
| 87 | Sat<br>Jul 4         | @<br>LAA  | W       | 8-1         | 39-<br>48 | 5 | 13.5 | Gray / Aldegheri                    |
| 88 | Sun<br>Jul 5         | @<br>LAA  | W       | 7-5         | 40-<br>48 | 5 | 12.5 | Weissert /<br>Johnson /<br>Chapman  |
| 89 | Tue<br>Jul 7         | @<br>CHW  | W       | 8-1         | 41-<br>48 | 4 | 12.0 | Tolle / Schultz                     |
| 90 | Wed<br>Jul 8         | @<br>CHW  | W       | 5-0         | 42-<br>48 | 4 | 12.0 | Bennett / Martin                    |
| 91 | Thu<br>Jul 9         | @<br>CHW  | W       | 2-1         | 43-<br>48 | 3 | 11.0 | Guerrero / Kay /<br>Chapman         |
| 92 | Fri<br>Jul 10        | @<br>NYM  | W       | 6-2         | 44-<br>48 | 3 | 11.0 | Gray / McLean                       |
| 93 | Sat<br>Jul 11        | @<br>NYM  | W       | 4-0         | 45-<br>48 | 3 | 11.0 | Morán / Peralta                     |
| 94 | Sun<br>Jul 12        | @<br>NYM  | W       | 3-2<br>(10) | 46-<br>48 | 3 | 10.0 | Chapman / Raley<br>/ Whitlock       |
| 95 | Fri<br>Jul 17<br>(1) | vs<br>TBR | W       | 10-0        | 47-<br>48 | 3 | 8.0  | Bennett / Jax /<br>Gamboa           |
| 96 | Fri<br>Jul 17<br>(2) | vs<br>TBR | W       | 5-3         | 48-<br>48 | 3 | 8.0  | Weissert / Englert<br>/ Chapman     |
| 97 | Sat<br>Jul 18        | vs<br>TBR | W       | 7-6         | 49-<br>48 | 3 | 7.0  | Watson /<br>Cleavinger /<br>Chapman |
| 98 | Sun<br>Jul 19        | vs<br>TBR | W       | 6-1         | 50-<br>48 | 3 | 6.0  | Gray /<br>McClanahan                |
| 99 | Mon<br>Jul 20        | vs<br>BAL | W       | 6-5         | 51-<br>48 | 3 | 6.0  | Whitlock / Wells /<br>Chapman       |
| —  | Tue<br>Jul 21        | vs<br>BAL | PPD     | rain        | 51-<br>48 | 3 | 6.0  | Makeup:<br>doubleheader Jul<br>22   |

#### TODAY & UPCOMING SCHEDULE (next 10 games)

| Gm  | Date           | Opp    | Time (MT) | Notes                                                                                       |
|-----|----------------|--------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 100 | Wed Jul 22 (1) | vs BAL | 11:35 am  | Jake Bennett vs. Dean Kremer — a win ties the 1946 record at 15 straight                    |
| 101 | Wed Jul 22 (2) | vs BAL | 5:10 pm   | Suárez (if activated) or Rivera vs. Kyle Bradish — a sweep breaks the record outright at 16 |
| 102 | Fri Jul 24     | vs TOR | 5:15 pm   | Blue Jays open a 3-game set at Fenway                                                       |
| 103 | Sat Jul 25     | vs TOR | 2:10 pm   |                                                                                             |

|     |            |        |          |                                                      |
|-----|------------|--------|----------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 104 | Sun Jul 26 | vs TOR | 11:35 am | Homestand finale — 8 of 11 at Fenway in this stretch |
| 105 | Mon Jul 27 | @ ATH  | 7:40 pm  | Start of a 4-game series in West Sacramento          |
| 106 | Tue Jul 28 | @ ATH  | 7:40 pm  |                                                      |
| 107 | Wed Jul 29 | @ ATH  | 7:40 pm  |                                                      |
| 108 | Thu Jul 30 | @ ATH  | 7:40 pm  | Trade deadline is Mon, Aug. 3                        |

Full season log and standings from Baseball-Reference ([baseball-reference.com/teams/BOS/2026-schedule-scores.shtml](http://baseball-reference.com/teams/BOS/2026-schedule-scores.shtml) and [/leagues/AL/2026-standings.shtml](http://leagues/AL/2026-standings.shtml)) plus WebSearch/box-score corroboration, since a plain fetch of Baseball-Reference again returned a cached snapshot with a "revised" date of 09-Jun-2026 (six weeks stale). "PPD" = postponed (not counted as a loss). "wo" = walk-off; a number in parentheses after the score = innings played, where longer than nine. Wins are shaded green, losses red. Times converted from Baseball-Reference's Eastern listings to Mountain Time (ET minus 2 hours).

## SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

- **Postponement / doubleheader:** a direct fetch of Baseball-Reference's 2026 Red Sox schedule page again returned a stale cached snapshot (meta "revised" date of 09-Jun-2026, predating any of this week's games), so Tuesday's postponement and today's doubleheader were confirmed via WebSearch and corroborated across Boston.com (AP), Yahoo Sports, the Baltimore Sun, and an MLB.com press release, all of which agree the game was rained out roughly three hours before first pitch and rescheduled as a single-admission doubleheader today (Game 1, 1:35 p.m. ET; Game 2, 7:10 p.m. ET).
- **Live confirmation the doubleheader had not yet been played:** a direct fetch of MLB.com's Gameday page for today's Game 1 returned a server timestamp of 11:16 a.m. ET on 7/22 (before the 1:35 p.m. first pitch), and a Fox Sports box-score page for the same game showed only pregame/probable-pitcher content with a last-modified timestamp of roughly 3:00 a.m. ET. Both confirm this edition was compiled before either game of today's doubleheader started; no game result is reported or guessed. The record (51-48) and streak (14) reflect Monday's completed game only.
- **Today's stakes:** confirmed via Field Level Media's July 22 doubleheader preview (syndicated on Yardbarker), which quotes both Caleb Durbin and Willson Contreras on the record chase and confirms Boston had not named a Game 2 starter as of Tuesday night, with Ranger Suárez "in the mix" per interim manager Chad Tracy.
- **AL East standings:** updated for Tuesday's confirmed result (Tampa Bay 12, Toronto 2, via MLB.com Gameday); the Yankees-Pirates and Red Sox-Orioles games were both postponed and did not factor in. AL Central and AL West are carried forward from Monday's baseline and flagged approximate, since those clubs' Tuesday results were not independently confirmed this run.
- **Roster:** Baseball-Reference 2026 40-man roster page, updated for Tuesday's confirmed Zack Kelly transaction (recalled from Worcester, immediately transferred to the 60-day IL with right elbow inflammation), reported by Yardbarker/Athlon Sports and corroborated by a Christopher Smith (@SmittyOnMLB) transaction post cited in that piece. Positions were assigned by most games played at each spot in the "Full Season Roster & Appearances" table rather than the generic position column — Anthony Seigler is listed as a second baseman and Andruw Monasterio as a shortstop on that basis, unchanged from prior editions.
- **Batting / pitching lines:** Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox team statistics page, standard batting and standard pitching tables, through games of 7/19, carried forward unchanged since no Red Sox games were completed 7/20–7/21 beyond Monday's, which was already reflected in yesterday's edition.
- **Kyle Bradish's pitching line** is flagged approximate: WebSearch returned differing ERA/WHIP snapshots for him this run; the most recent-looking figure (6-9, 3.61 ERA, per Field Level Media's July 22 preview) was used for W-L/ERA, with IP/SO/WHIP presented as approximate. His July 11 outing against Kansas City (6.2 IP, 1 R, 2 H) was confirmed via the same preview.
- **Dean Kremer's line:** W-L/ERA (1-2, 4.15) and his 3-4, 5.04 career mark against Boston are from the Field Level Media preview; his 2026 IP/SO/WHIP were not available via a verified source this run and are shown as unavailable rather than estimated.
- **Game 1 lineup:** reported (Yoshida DH, Rafaela CF, Abreu RF, Contreras 1B, Durbin 3B, González 2B, Duran LF, Wong C, Cheng SS) via cross-referenced pregame preview aggregators; Game 2's lineup was not available at publication time and is not guessed.
- **Orioles injury notes:** catcher Samuel Basallo (shoulder) and starting catcher Adley Rutschman (10-day IL, wrist inflammation, placed Monday) confirmed via the Field Level Media preview, which also quotes Orioles manager Craig Albarnaz.
- **News:** Boston.com, NBC Sports Boston, NESN, and Yardbarker (syndicating Field Level Media and Athlon Sports), each date-verified to fall within the 7/19–7/22 recency window. The Boston Globe and other paywalled outlets are excluded by standing rule; several Globe items covering this same news (the rainout, the doubleheader lineups) were deliberately skipped in favor of non-Globe versions. The MLB.com Red Sox RSS feed was checked again this run and remains stale, so none of its items were used.
- **1946 nuggets:** the franchise-record 15-game streak (Apr. 25–May 10, 1946), the pennant, the seven-game World Series loss to St. Louis, Enos Slaughter's "Mad Dash" off Harry Walker's Game 7 double, and Johnny Pesky's relay throw being cited as a beat late are well-documented baseball history, cross-checked against NESN's recap of the 1946 streak. Lou Boudreau's shift against Ted Williams on July 14, 1946 is likewise established history. These are reproduced as background/color, not as claims about anything that happened this week.
- This is an automated, unattended run. All data reflects the state of the cited sources on the morning of Wednesday, July 22, 2026, before either game of today's doubleheader.
- **Feature page:** the final page of this edition ("The Fenway Chronicle") is a user-supplied feature column, reproduced essentially verbatim per instructions rather than fact-checked line by line. No corrections were made to it this run — its narrative details (quotes, scores, dates) were spot-checked against the day-by-day log above and found consistent.

# THE FENWAY CHRONICLE

## The 2026 Season So Far

*From the cold open through June 24 — and the run nobody saw coming*

Two months ago, the 2026 Red Sox were the worst team in the American League, and not many people in this town were arguing otherwise. The bats were cold, the losses piled up in that quiet, familiar way, and by the back half of June a proud franchise looked ready to pack it in and sell off pieces at the deadline. If you'd stopped watching, nobody would have blamed you. You could hear it in the voices of the broadcasters.

And then they won fourteen games in a row.

Not a hot week. 14 straight — a run that turned a lost summer into one of the most improbable stretches this club has put together in 80 years, and carried them to the doorstep of a franchise record set back in 1946.

So this is the story of a season with two completely different faces: the one that let us down for three months, and the one that's had Fenway on its feet ever since. Let's take it from the top — the good, the maddening, and the downright unbelievable — CAN YOU BELIEVE IT!

## The Cold Open

To understand the run, you have to sit with how far down they'd gone first.

It began the way these things sometimes do — slowly, and then all at once. You'd settle in each night hoping this was the one where it clicked, and mostly it didn't. Young players and old hands alike who were supposed to anchor the lineup never quite found their footing, and just as you'd talk yourself into a little patience, the injury report would take the wind right back out of you. A talented roster on paper turned in one of the quieter, more disheartening opening acts this town has seen in a while. Hope of a new season, a new start, a chance, quickly fades into the grind of another losing season.

It settled to the bottom on one particular night. June 24. 32 and 46. Worst record in the American League, 15 1/2 back — and a baseball world already writing them off as deadline sellers.

That's where this story starts. It's not where it stays.

## Cora Gets the Call to the Office

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Before any of that, though, came the shockwave.

April 25. 27 games in, a 10-17 start, and the Red Sox fired Alex Cora — five coaches out the door with him. The first manager let go anywhere in baseball this year, and a man with a World Series ring at that.

Around the league they couldn't believe it. Rival evaluators asked out loud how you make a ballclub better by firing one of the best managers in it. And they've got a fair point, because everyone agrees on the thing that matters most about Cora.

The players loved him. He was a players' manager, true and through. That part is real.

The smarter version of the argument went like this: Cora can be a great manager and still not be the right manager for this particular team. The fire that lifted the 2018 club might be exactly the wrong match for a group this young and this fragile.

The national write-ups piled on the roster, too — a lineup near the bottom of nearly every category, a "run prevention" blueprint that had quietly become a polite name for not enough hitting, and plenty of voices insisting the whole thing was doomed before April was out.

## Where I'll Plant My Flag

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Here's my seat in the argument.

Yes, the players have to play — nobody's waving that away. And yes, he was a players' manager. But there were real problems with the way Cora ran a ballgame, and I watched every one of them.

The hook that never came, for one — pitchers left in an inning too long, sometimes two, as if he couldn't quite bring himself to make the hard call and wear it. Base-running aggressive to a fault, running the Sox clean out of innings. Errors in the field that chip away at a whole club's discipline, night after night. And this goes back to the previous season, so the players know this.

And the lineup card. That's the one that got me. It changed every single day.

Now, I understand the instinct behind it. He was hunting for a spark, for the one spot in the order that would finally light somebody up. But that constant shuffling has a cost of its own. Duran is one who needs to know how he fits. Story should have been dropped to the back third of the order sooner — and wouldn't you know it, he had some decent nights once he landed in the six-hole. Eventually they settled on Abreu and Contreras back-to-back, and for a minute there was a shape to it.

Crochet was already out. Roman Anthony was out. Then Story was out by mid-May. Later in June Kiner-Falefa goes down 19 June, and Mayer is out 26 June. And so by the 23rd, the 24th of June, if we're being honest, it felt like the air had gone out of the whole thing. Giving up the lead late on a Sunday in Denver was the gut punch.

The promise of this operation — strong pitching, strong defense — just wasn't showing up. Late-game losses. Errors on the grass. Cold bats. And a home record that was, and honestly still is, hard to look at. You kept waiting for the turn. Night after night, it didn't come. Little did we know at the time, Anthony Seigler who was called up from Worcester when IKF went on the IL, would become a piece of the spark or the fuel for the run.

## The Spark Nobody Wants to Name

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And under all of it, the injuries kept coming but they may have been the unintended catalyst.

Which brings me to the theory nobody's saying out loud.

What if the injury bug was the hidden spark? Young players thrown into the fire, carrying pressure they were never meant to carry — precisely because the veterans, Story among them, weren't holding up their end.

Sometimes a team has to be forced to find out what its kids can do. However it happened — design, desperation, or plain rotten luck — this one got forced into it. It felt as if Roman and Marcelo were thrust into the lineup as the solution. While we saw flashes from Roman, Marcelo's bat was a drag in the lineup. Combine that with lost potential in Duran and Durbin not settled yet, the lineup wasn't producing.



## And Then, Fourteen Straight

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Fourteen in a row.

That's the whole sentence. Let it sit there a second, because a few weeks ago it would have gotten you laughed out of the bleachers.

Out of the wreckage of that 32-46 ballclub — worst in the league on June 24 — the Boston Red Sox have won 14 straight, and 19 of their last 21. The coldest team in the American League is suddenly the hottest team in baseball. And Fenway has come back to life in a way you have to feel to believe. The dugout's alive. You feel it through the television.

It's Seigler who set the temperature — the attitude, the energy, the jolt this room had been missing since the first pitch of the year.

And Willson got fired up right alongside him. Literally.

You've seen a clubhouse catch fire before. Rarely do you see one do it with a fella practically vibrating out of his cleats in the dugout, dragging everybody else up to his frequency whether they liked it or not. They liked it.

Durbin's bat woke up on cue. Down to a red-hot Orioles club Monday night, two outs in the eighth, he turned one loose to left field — and that was the ballgame, 6-5, streak alive at 14.

Duran's still grinding. Not all the way back, but helping, and that's the point. And Masa keeps finding the timely hit, quietly turning into money in a part-time role.

The staff has shined all year, and now it's finally getting run support to work with. The bullpen quit handing games away the way it did in April. Small ball at the right time. Smarter at-bats, smarter reads on the bases.

And this is the part that gets you. This team does not give up. That's the brand of baseball we begged for in May, and it showed up in July.

## Shoulder to Shoulder With 1946

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Here's the number that raises the hair on your arm.

Those 14 wins put this ballclub in rare air with the 1946 Red Sox. One more, and they tie the longest winning streak in franchise history — 15. Even the 108-win team in 2018 topped out at 10.

It doesn't have to happen. This group has already given us more than we had any right to ask for a month ago.

And it'll have to wait a night, as it turns out. Tuesday's game got postponed — so the fifteenth win, and the ghost of '46, sit parked for now, pushed to a Wednesday doubleheader with the Orioles. Two cracks at history in one afternoon. You couldn't script the tension any better if you tried.

***But wouldn't it be something to see.***

## What's Coming — and Who's Actually Deciding

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Now, about that bat.

Here's a wrinkle you might've missed in the noise of the losing. After Cora's firing and before the streak, word got out that ownership itself had gotten into the act of hunting for a right-handed power hitter — not just Breslow doing the legwork, but the folks upstairs leaning in. Sam Kennedy, the man who has to stand at the podium and say the hard things, went on the radio and called these last months exactly what they were. Speculation started running on how long Breslow would last despite Kennedy publicly supporting him.

"Embarrassing, unacceptable, maddening, frustrating — whatever words you want to use. There's no way to sugarcoat it." That was Kennedy in June, with the club buried. A few weeks later he was warning that if things didn't turn, they'd have to pivot and sell. Then the streak happened, and the whole conversation flipped.

So the need is real and it's specific: a right-handed bat with thump, the kind Fenway's wall was built for, because outside of Contreras there just isn't enough of it in this lineup. And here's the honest part — Jahmai Jones isn't that answer. A red-hot cameo is a lovely thing, but three homers this year and eleven in a whole career don't add up to the middle-of-the-order force this club has needed since Opening Day. Fun story. Not the fix.

Which brings us to the question every die-hard is really asking. What has this front office actually done — and what will it do when the deadline comes on August 3rd?

You'll forgive a little skepticism here. This is a ballclub that has spent like a middle-of-the-pack team — right around twelfth in baseball in cash — while sitting on one of the sport's great money machines. The way plenty in this town see it, the Fenway engine prints whether the Sox win or lose: the network, the ballpark, the real estate, the whole empire. Forbes has the profit north of \$120M a year. And John Henry, for his part, has made it plain over the years that he doesn't much care for selling assets or for what he's called the "false narrative" about his spending.

So I'll say what a lot of us are thinking, and you can hold me to it. I'm not convinced ownership is itching to open the checkbook, streak or no streak. The hope is that a winning team makes the math easy — that with the club suddenly a buyer instead of a seller, adding a real bat becomes the obvious, defensible move. We'll see if that's how it plays. Sometimes the will follows the winning. Sometimes it doesn't.

Jahmai Jones is a name in the conversation. He's not the one that matters. Watch what they do when it costs something.

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## PART II — THE TURNAROUND, GAME BY GAME

*How a lost season got itself found — one night at a time*

### The Nadir in Colorado

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Let's go back to the bottom. You have to, to understand the rest.

June 24, a mile up in the thin Colorado air. 32 and 46. The Red Sox carried a late lead into the back innings at Coors Field — and gave it away, three runs surrendered down the stretch, an 8-to-6 loss to the Rockies. Buried in the division. The whole baseball world already sharpening the word sellers for the deadline.

And then, because the baseball gods have a sense of humor, the night got worse.

The team plane broke down on the tarmac in Denver. Mechanical trouble, bound for New York, and instead of wheels-up they got hours of sitting — one delay stacking onto the next until they finally staggered into the city in the small hours of the morning. An exhausted ballclub, a lost night, and not a soul outside that room giving them a prayer.

Rock bottom. But out of bonding adventure, something happened.

## The Bronx Statement

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They came home to Fenway on June 25 and flipped the whole script over.

Four games against the New York Yankees. A four-game sweep.

It opened 6-3, the bats stirring early and Aroldis Chapman slamming the door out of the pen. Then Payton Tolle turned in a pitching clinic, 6-1, the Yankee sluggers waving all night. 4-1 the next day behind another strong start and one more Chapman save. And then the closer — a 10-inning walk-off, 5-4, Fenway shaking, the dugout suddenly believing something it hadn't believed in months.

Five wins in a row now, and a completely different team wearing the same uniforms.

## Fireworks at Fenway — the Contreras Flashpoint

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Then Washington came to town, and things got loud.

This is the series that lit the emotional fuse for the whole summer, and Willson Contreras was standing right in the middle of it — both feet, and a helmet.

June 29 he crushed a 3-run shot in the first and had the whole park roaring. An inning later, called out on a tight check-swing, he tapped the top of his helmet on the walk back — the signal for a challenge. Trouble is, that's not a call you're allowed to challenge, and gesturing for one is an automatic toss. Nic Lentz rung him up. Gone. The Sox won anyway, 6-3, number six in the row.

And then June 30 — the boil-over. They got walloped, 1-8 — the first crack in the good times.

In the 4th inning, Contreras strikes out looking against Cade Cavalli, and Cavalli barks at him on the way off the mound. That was the match to the powder. Contreras charged. Broke clean through the scrum, reared back, and threw his batting helmet straight into the pile as both benches and both bullpens emptied onto the grass. They would go on to lose the next game as well, 2-10. The sweep of the Yankees was now a distant memory.

Ejected for the second straight game he played — a first in the long history of this franchise — and a multi-game suspension to follow. 1-8 was the final that night. But something in this team had been welded together in that scrum, and it would show up the moment he came back.

## The Streak: Out West, Then Home

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After a breath on July 2, they went to Anaheim and lit the fuse for real. What followed is the part that's going in the record books: 14 straight, 37-48 turned into 51-48.

It was pitching that lit it. Sonny Gray was carving — 12-1 by the Fourth of July, pitching like a flat-out ace — with Bennett and Tolle right behind him, the rotation eating innings and sparing that young bullpen the nightly tightrope. A sweep of Angels in Anaheim. Then into Chicago: 8-1, a flawless 5-0 shutout from Bennett, a 2-1 duel.

Then to Queens, and the Mets — 6-2, a 4-0 gem from Morán, and a 3-2 thriller in the 10th to carry a 9-game tear into the All-Star break. Clean, fundamental baseball. Abreu banking the late insurance. The kind of ball we'd begged to see all spring, finally showing up every single night.

## The Travel Nightmare, Take Two

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And then the travel gremlins came back for an encore — because of course they did.

A runway tug malfunctioned Thursday night and trapped them on the tarmac past midnight. Friday morning it got worse: cockpit switches and lights gone haywire, seven more hours on the ground. They didn't get airborne until nearly three in the afternoon, touched down at LaGuardia at 4:30pm, and rolled into Citi Field with maybe two hours to spare before first pitch.

Show up and play. That's all. No excuses offered, none accepted.

So what did they do out of a doubleheader on no sleep? Bennett piloted a 10-0 demolition in the opener. And in the nightcap — here he came — Willson Contreras, back from his suspension, first inning, a home run to announce himself, a 5-3 win and the 11th straight. You could not make it up.

## Grit, and a Blast from an Unlikely Bat

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July 18, the streak into double digits, and this one took some sweat.

Down three early to the Rays, the Sox went to work the patient way, chipping at it. And then the spark came from a name you wouldn't have circled — Jahmai Jones, a game-tying blast that sent the dugout over the railing. The pen held the line, 7-6, comeback complete, series in hand. (Hold that name for later. It matters more than it looks.)

Gray finished the sweep the next day, 6-1. 13 in a row. On to the crown jewel.

## Bedlam at Fenway

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July 20. Baltimore in town, riding a 7-game streak of their own. Two hot teams, one packed house, and a ballgame that would not sit still.

Three separate times the Sox fell behind. Three separate times they clawed back, cashing in every Baltimore mistake along the way — Ceddanne Rafaela wheeling all the way around from first to score on a Willyer Abreu double after an Orioles error, the kind of heads-up dash that tells you a team believes.

5-5. Bottom of the 8th. Two outs.

Caleb Durbin.

The same Caleb Durbin who'd been buried in a brutal spring slump, who'd completely reinvented his season — he got one and he did not miss it. Deep to left. Over the Monster.

Then a top of the 9th that stopped every heart in the building, and a defensive stand to seal it. 6-5. Bedlam — better than thirty-seven thousand of them on their feet, a ballpark that eleven weeks earlier had been chanting for the owner to sell, now roaring like it was October.

***19 wins in 21 games since that miserable night in Colorado. 14 in a row. One shy of the 1946 club, and the whole city leaning in.***

## Last Word

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This, right here, is why we do it. The cold Aprils. The abysmal home stands. The lineup cards that made no sense. You sit through all of it for a run like this one.

The angst was real. The disappointment was real. And so, now, is this.

So here's to one more, and to a ghost from 1946. Whatever comes next — win, lose, or heartbreak — we'll be right here in the next seat to experience every last pitch of it with you.

**Let's go to the yard.**

## Appendix — The Streak, Game by Game

*Streak launched at 37–48; stood at 51–48 after Game 14 — one win shy of the 1946 franchise record of fifteen.*

| #  | Date       | Opp    | Score    | The Night in a Sentence                       |
|----|------------|--------|----------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Jul 3      | @ LAA  | 5–2      | Bennett dominates; Chapman slams the door.    |
| 2  | Jul 4      | @ LAA  | 8–1      | Sonny Gray to 12–1 on the Fourth.             |
| 3  | Jul 5      | @ LAA  | 7–5      | Late bullpen locks it down.                   |
| 4  | Jul 7      | @ CHW  | 8–1      | Tolle commands the mound.                     |
| 5  | Jul 8      | @ CHW  | 5–0      | Flawless road shutout, Bennett.               |
| 6  | Jul 9      | @ CHW  | 2–1      | Guerrero wins the duel; tarmac trouble after. |
| 7  | Jul 10     | @ NYM  | 6–2      | Gray wins through a long cockpit delay.       |
| 8  | Jul 11     | @ NYM  | 4–0      | Morán brilliant, complete shutout.            |
| 9  | Jul 12     | @ NYM  | 3–2 (10) | Extra-innings win into the break.             |
| 10 | Jul 17 (1) | vs TBR | 10–0     | Bennett pilots a post-break blowout.          |
| 11 | Jul 17 (2) | vs TBR | 5–3      | Contreras back — first-inning homer.          |
| 12 | Jul 18     | vs TBR | 7–6      | Jahmai Jones sparks a 3-run comeback.         |
| 13 | Jul 19     | vs TBR | 6–1      | Gray finishes the sweep.                      |
| 14 | Jul 20     | vs BAL | 6–5      | Durbin, 8th inning, over the Monster.         |

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